

■ B.3.10 Protection

Mathematica allows you to make assignments that override the standard operation and meaning of built-in *Mathematica* objects.

To make it difficult to make such assignments by mistake, most built-in *Mathematica* objects have the attribute **Protected**. If you want to make an assignment for a built-in object, you must first remove this attribute. You can do this by calling the function **Unprotect**.

There are a few fundamental *Mathematica* objects to which you absolutely cannot assign your own values. These objects carry the attribute **Locked**, as well as **Protected**. The **Locked** attribute prevents you from changing any of the attributes, and thus from removing the **Protected** attribute.